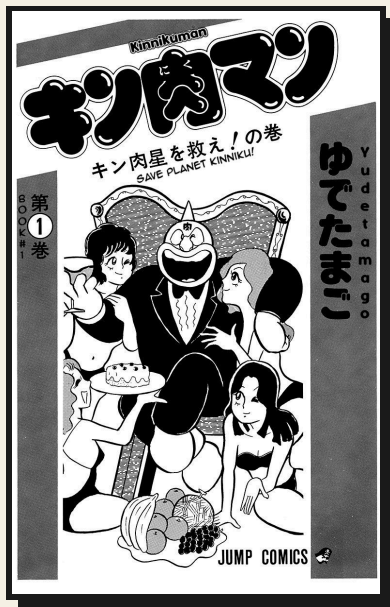




キン肉マン・イン・アメリカ

MUSCLE MAN

KINNIKUMAN IN AMERICA

WRITTEN BY MAX COYNE-GREEN

BASED ON KINNIKUMAN BY YUDETAMAGO (YOSHINORI NAKAI & TAKASHI SHIMADA)

FEBRUARY 2026 • CONFIDENTIAL

Space Kaiju Attack!

宇宙怪獣襲来 の巻



... Is approaching



The greatest threat the
Earth has ever faced...



The Year, 1979

ORIGINAL TRANSLATION:
AK OF TROY
EDITS AND ENHANCEMENTS:
->AKUMATSU TRANSLATIONS<-

45 years of Yudetamago's creativity. 85 million copies. One character.

ART: YUDETAMAGO · KINNIKUMAN CH.1 · SHUEISHA

THE PITCH

WHO IS KINNUKAMAN?

Ask any American, and you'll hear...nothing.

Even with 85 million copies of the original manga sold, the series has little recognition in the US and none outside manga loyalists.

What a shame. Because a slovenly, garlic-powered underdog who ditches his royal inheritance in favor of *food and friendship*?

That is a character Americans would love.

With wrestling storming back into the American mainstream, and animated projects dominating box offices, there's never been a better time to bring Kinnikuman to America.

And that's exactly what we plan to do.

THE APPROACH

STARTING IN AMERICA

provides an entry point for new audiences. This introduces the world with the character. No need for a wiki page or a full act of lore. The audience learns the world within the story – setting up the franchise to step back into the canon or forward into new sequels and series.

THE ROOTS

are in manga, but the presentation doesn't have to be. There's a clear path to mainstream success that doesn't get this property siloed off as "another anime." Luckily, there's 45 years of Yudetamago's creativity to translate and build upon. Despite its galactic scale, their world is human-centered. And despite their

outrageous comedy, their stories are grounded in the types of thematic and emotional arcs that make PIXAR and DREAMWORKS films instant classic box-office hits.

MODERN CLASSICS

like THE LEGO MOVIE and INTO THE SPIDERVERSE introduce honored franchises to new audiences with the utmost commitment to the craft of storytelling. These are not kids movies. They are some of the finest written fictional texts of the era – so well written that they work at any age.

When you drill into these scripts, you find emotional mature story arcs anchored to thematic architecture that makes them resonate across generations. Their structures are so sharp that kids go on meaningful journeys without realizing it. Adults cry about plastic bricks and cartoon pigs.

And that starts with the strategic choice of protagonist. Not invulnerable superheros. Not chosen messiahs. But normal people. The modern masterpieces are underdog stories, because that's what Americans love. And that's what Yudetamago has created.

Kinnikuman's entries to US media have struggled in different ways. 4Kids made a sanitized kids' version that stripped out the thematic tissue and adult humor. Netflix's Perfect Origin Arc tried to replicate the manga in series form and front-loaded so much lore that newcomers bounced off it.

Both started with the world and expected the audience to care. That's backwards.

Instead, we start with character. A character so perfectly suited for the American market, people will forget the time before they knew him. And that brings us back to our first question...

The Beauty and the Kaiju



In the manga: Japan's most famous joke → In our film: a guy working at a taco shop

ART: YUDETAMAGO · KINNIKUMAN CH.2 · SHUEISHA

THE CHARACTER

WHO IS KINNUKAMAN?

He's ROCKY meets SHREK. He's slovenly. He's unpretentious. And sometimes he's a goddamn hero. He eats junk food that makes him stronger. He was thrown away by his own parents because his face didn't look right. And he refuses to stay down. And that's someone audiences will follow.

Maybe he's a prince with an infamous history in Japan.

But in America, he's just a guy working at a taco shop.

THE STORY

HIDING IN PLAIN SIGHT



ART: YUDETAMAGO · KINNIKUMAN CH.1 · SHUEISHA

Kinnikuman is hiding. He's a Chojin — a superhuman wrestler — but in America, that doesn't mean much. The world has all kinds of strange-looking beings walking around. Nobody stares. Chojin wrestling is massive in Japan, practically a religion. In America, it's a sideshow. The serious talent stays overseas because that's where the respect is.

He likes it that way. He eats bland food, avoids garlic, and covers the mark on his forehead. Most importantly, he doesn't talk about where he came from or all that's happened to him in Japan.

But this is America and that's perfectly normal. In fact, he loves it. If you know him, you know he's a prince. But there's no need to act like one in New York without fear

of shame. Because America is shameless. And he's finally at peace with who he is - even if no one knows who that really is.

And then one day, the taco shop is robbed and his friends are under threat. Until now, he's avoided fighting...but he's been eating garlic beef in the back. And his body moves before his brain catches up. One second he's a quiet guy behind the counter, the next he's put someone through a wall and demolished half the restaurant.

This is Burning Inner Strength — what happens when Kinnikuman's conscious mind gets out of the way and his body fights on pure instinct. He doesn't choose it. He definitely doesn't want it. And now he owes his boss for a destroyed taco shop.

An underground fight offer comes. He takes it for the money, trying to hold back. But soon enough, he's going full Chojin. Word spreads fast. He picks up a few more fights — small-time underground circuit stuff. Some local promoter starts booking him. It's grimy, it's anonymous, and it pays. That's all Kinnikuman wants.

But you can't hide that kind of talent for long.

ACT 2

TERRY MANN

is an American Chojin — the only one who's made a real name for himself stateside. Part wrestler, part promoter, he's Vince McMahon if McMahon could actually fight.

He trained in Japan, came home, and he's been trying to build Chojin wrestling in America for years. The problem is no top Japanese talent will relocate to a market that doesn't respect them. Terryman's been waiting for a star. He just found one.

He recruits Kinnikuman into his circuit. It's small-time — B-tier fighters, modest venues — but it's real. Kinnikuman accepts for the money, not the glory. He's still hiding. Just in a new costume. And he tears through the competition. Not because he's great — because the American league is weak. The talent gap between the US and Japanese circuits is massive. But the crowd doesn't care about rankings. They see a shameless, weird, pig-faced fighter who wins ugly.

And America loves an underdog.

AND THAT'S WHEN MEAT SHOWS UP



ART: YUDETAMAGO · KINNIKUMAN CH.2 · SHUEISHA

His tiny, loyal trainer has been searching the galaxy for him. And finally, he hears about the new chojin in New York and comes to find his prince. Soon, Meat becomes his new trainer and corner man. But Kinnikuman won't talk about the past. He's trying to have both lives — American fame with Japanese identity hidden.

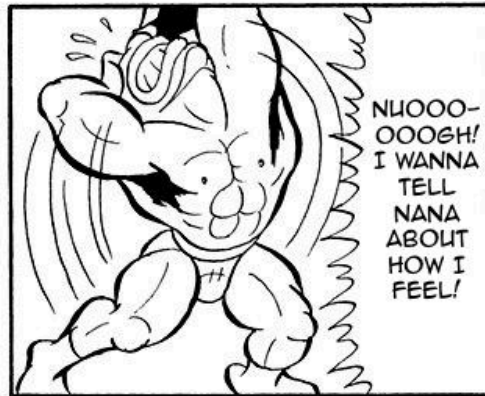
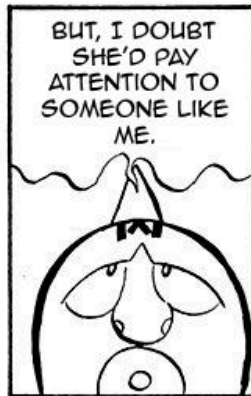
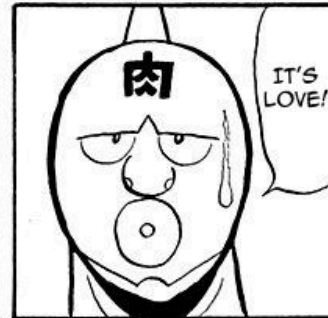
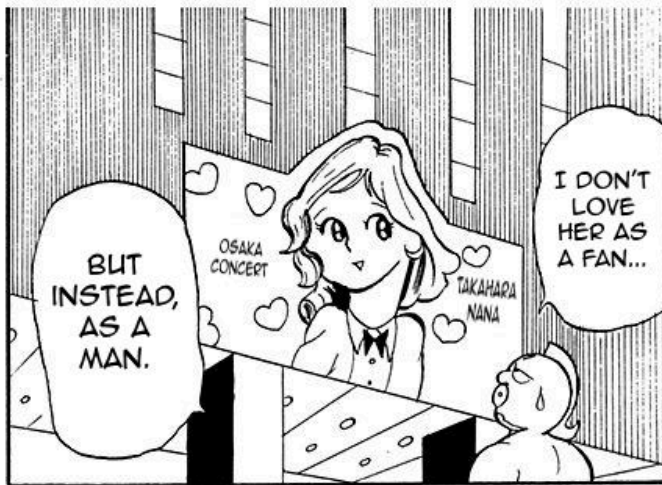
At their next match, Meat introduces Kinnikuman...the crown prince of Planet Kinniku

The crowd goes silent. Then confused.

"Wait — pig face? The garlic guy? That's the LOSER from Japan?"

His cover is blown. Two lives just collided in public. And there's no going back.

EVERYTHING GETS WORSE



SFX: THUD! THUD!

SFX: SIZZLE! CRACKLE!



SFX: FWOOSH!



*In the manga: shame about his face, his mask, his identity → In our film: the same wound,
a new continent*

ART: YUDETAMAGO · KINNIKUMAN CH.2 · SHUEISHA

Everything gets worse from here.

Terryman learns the full story and does what a promoter does: sees the angle. Exiled prince versus his homeland? That's a main event. He books elite Japanese Chojin fighters for a marquee show at Madison Square Garden — without Kinnikuman's consent. He tells himself it's good for everybody. It's good for business. And here's the thing — he's not entirely wrong. Kinnikuman does need to face his past. Terryman's just doing it for the wrong reasons.

ROBIN MASK

leads the Japanese contingent. He's the reigning champion — technical perfection, aristocratic, everything Kinnikuman was supposed to be. Robin isn't here for the throne. He's here because Kinnikuman's American celebrity is an insult to their entire tradition. A coward who ran is now famous? In a weak league? Robin's mission is to show America what Japan already knows.

And he does. Robin publicly narrates Kinnikuman's complete history of failure. Every embarrassment. Every loss. The beloved underdog gets reframed as a fraud. The American crowd doesn't know what to believe anymore.

Kinnikuman blames Meat for blowing his cover. Pushes him away — the one person who never stopped believing in him. Quits. Tries to disappear.

But he can't. His anonymity is gone forever. Everyone saw. The taco shop life is over. He can't go back to being invisible, and he won't step forward.

Robin and the Japanese fighters challenge Kinnikuman's American circuit friends to real matches. These are legitimate Chojin fights — the Americans will be destroyed. The talent gap guarantees it. It's a trap: if the prince won't fight, his friends fight for him.

This is worse than where he started. Before the movie, he was hiding and nobody knew. Now he's hiding and everyone knows. The one coping mechanism he had is permanently broken.

Wherever Kinnikuman is hiding, Meat shows up. Doesn't give a speech. Doesn't try to convince him. Just sits there. Because that's what Meat does — he never leaves.



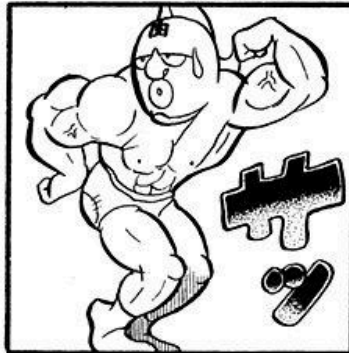
ACT 5

THE PATTERN BREAKS

SFX: WHIP!

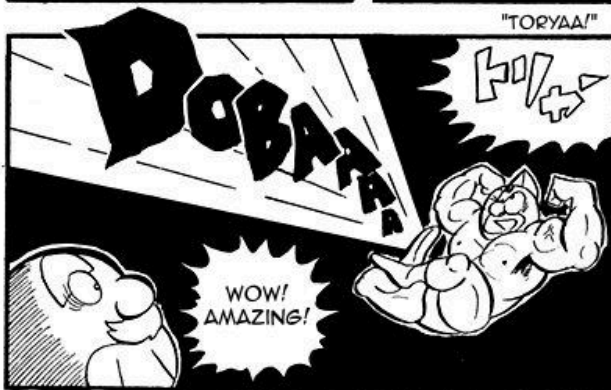


SFX: WHOOSH!



WELL,
HERE
IT
GOES.

"TORYAA!"



WOW!
AMAZING!



THAT'S GREAT
AND ALL, BUT
HOW LONG IS
THIS GONNA
TAKE?

SFX: FWOOSH!



EAT SOME
NICE,
FRESHLY
ROASTED
GARLIC...

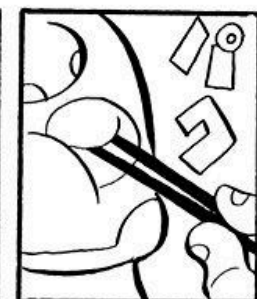
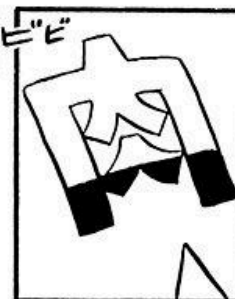
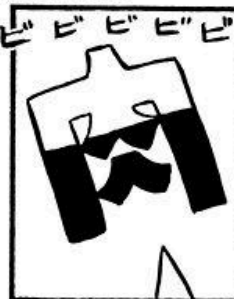
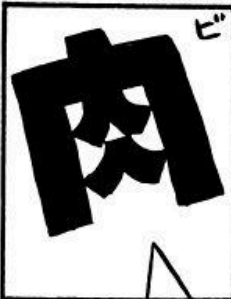
IT'S AT TIMES
LIKE THIS THAT
I LIKE TO USE
MY SPECIAL
JUMP™ BRAND
LIGHTER AND,

UUGH...
THIS MOVE
USES UP
A LOT OF
MY GARLIC
ENERGY...

SFX: WOBBLE!



SFX: BIIIBIIIBIIIBII



The garlic energy sequence. The mark glows. This is the moment our film's climax is built from.

ART: YUDETAMAGO · KINNIKUMAN CH.1 · SHUEISHA

That's not a magic power. That's friendship.

Kinnikuman learns the matches are happening. The B-tier American fighters — the little guys who welcomed him, the people who actually believed in the underdog — are going to face elite Japanese Chojin at Madison Square Garden. They'll be broken. Because of him. Because he ran.

And that's when it clicks. Running from the people who love you is exactly what his father did to him. He's been repeating the pattern his whole life. He left Japan because he was ashamed. He pushed Meat away because he was ashamed. The shame never went anywhere — he just kept finding new people to run from.

He won't be his father. He won't throw someone away.

He eats garlic. And gets ready to fight.

THE MANGA'S MOST ICONIC BEAT

DO YOU GIVE UP?

1

NO.

2

NO.

3

NO.

This is the manga's most iconic beat, preserved here because the entire movie has been building to this question. Giving up is what Kinnikuman has been doing for years — every time he ran, every time he hid. Refusing to give up, in this ring, in front of everyone, is the first honest thing he's done.

MADISON SQUARE GARDEN

THE FIGHT

Kinnikuman walks into MSG knowing every person in the world can see exactly who he is. The prince who ran. The joke. Pig-face. Garlic man. He's choosing to be fully, completely seen — which is the one thing he's spent the entire movie avoiding. That's the sacrifice. Not his life. His hiding.

Terryman sees him arrive. Something breaks open. He realizes what he's done — used this person. He has a choice: businessman or friend. Stay in the skybox or step into the ring.

THE FIGHT AGAINST ROBIN MASK

isn't even close. Technical perfection against sloppy desperation. It's almost funny how outmatched Kinnikuman is. Robin is barely trying. Then the Tower Bridge. Robin's signature backbreaker. Kinnikuman's spine is bent to the limit.

Robin asks: "Do you give up?"

No.

Asks again.

No.

THREE TIMES

Kinnikuman tries to fight back with everything he's learned in America — Terryman's coaching, ring tricks, showmanship. Robin counters all of it. The American playbook isn't enough. The person he's been pretending to be can't win this fight.

Then his mind shuts off. Burning Inner Strength activates — and the animation changes. Frame rate shifts. The audience feels it before they understand it. Kinnikuman stops thinking and his body takes over. Moves he doesn't know. Precision he can't access when he's trying.

Terryman enters the ring. Uses the Calf Branding for the first time — the signature move he's been avoiding because of his prosthetic leg. He stops hiding his damage at the same moment Kinnikuman stops hiding his identity. They save each other by dropping the act.

And then the comedy delivers the emotional turn. Meat throws gyudon mid-fight. The crowd laughs. Kinnikuman eats it. And the garlic — the absurd, embarrassing, food-based power source that everyone mocked — shifts Burning Inner Strength into its second stage. Fighting for friends.

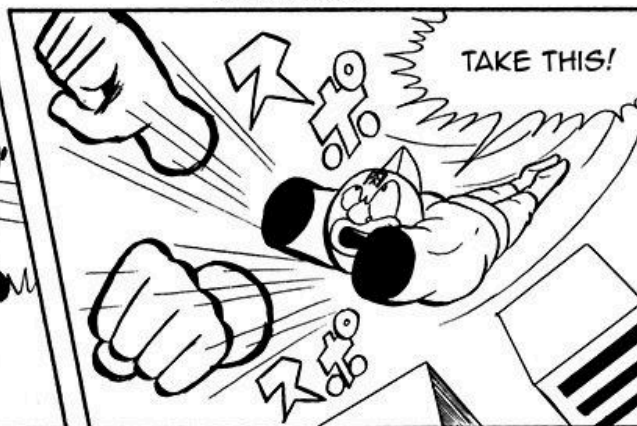
The comedy IS the power system. The power system IS the emotional climax.

The Kinniku Buster. The signature move. An 8-second unbroken shot — ground to apex to devastating impact. But the win is clean. Kinnikuman could destroy Robin. He doesn't. The finishing move wins without killing. Mercy over brutality.

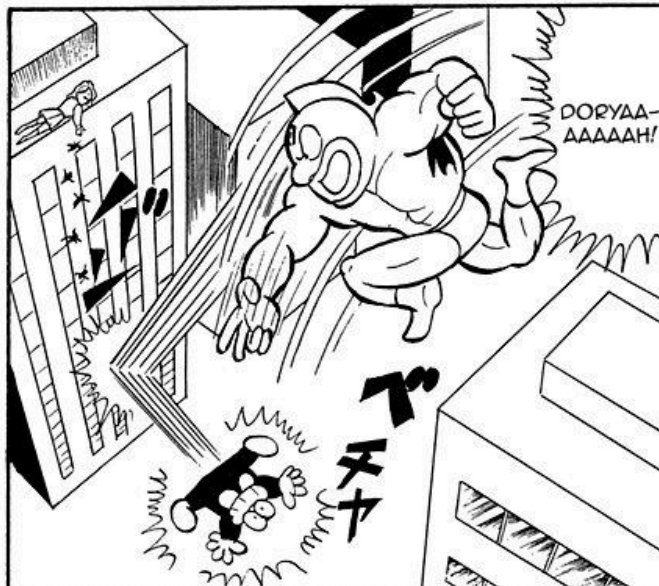
SFX: POW! WHAM! THWACK!



SFX: POP! POP!



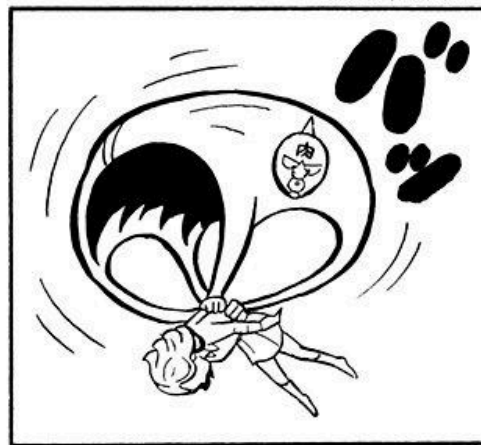
SFX: POW! CRAAAASH!



SFX: LANDING



SFX: FWOOMP!



In the manga: desperate, airborne, ugly → In our film: the same — but at Madison Square Garden

ART: YUDETAMAGO · KINNIKUMAN CH.1 · SHUEISHA

THE TURN

The Face Flash. During the finish, Kinnikuman's mask lifts slightly. Light erupts from underneath. The KIN mark appears on his forehead — the royal birthright he's been covering since page one. Nobody fully understands what it means. But they feel it. His identity manifesting not because he claimed it, but because he stopped running from it.

The crowd shifts. From confused, to divided, to chanting his name.

Robin, on the mat: "You're still the worst fighter I've ever seen." Beat. "But I've never seen anyone refuse to die like that."

Not a handshake. Not yet. A crack. The start of something the franchise will build on for years.



"I WIN IN THE END ANYWAY"

ART: YUDETAMAGO · KINNIKUMAN CH.2 · SHUEISHA

Kinnikuman walks out with Meat and Terryman. "Can we get gyudon?" He hasn't changed who he is. He's changed how he sees himself. That's the point.

***"YOU'RE STILL THE WORST FIGHTER I'VE EVER SEEN."
"BUT I'VE NEVER SEEN ANYONE REFUSE TO DIE LIKE THAT."***

— ROBIN MASK

THE CAST

THE CHARACTERS



KINNIKUMAN

THE UNWORTHY PRINCE

Kinnikuman / Suguru Kinniku. Born prince of Planet Kinniku. Thrown out of a spaceship as a baby because his randomly-assigned mask looked pig-faced and his father thought he was an actual pig. Grew up on Earth as Japan's most famous joke. Ran to America to disappear. Works a taco shop. Avoids garlic because it activates powers he doesn't want. His whole life is organized around not being seen.

What drives him isn't inadequacy — the standard underdog setup. It's shame. He wasn't rejected for failing at something. He was rejected for how he looked, before he ever did anything. That's a different wound, and it shapes everything. He doesn't think he needs to get better. He thinks he needs to not exist.

His fighting style is sloppy, desperate, accidental. His trainer Meat once named his flailing "the 48 Killer Moves" to give them some dignity. But when his conscious mind shuts off — beaten past thought, past fear — his body fights on pure instinct. This is Burning Inner Strength. It has three levels: fighting for survival, fighting for friends, and fighting for the sake of your enemy. Film one takes him through the first two. The third is the franchise's deepest territory.

His power source is garlic. Gyudon. Junk food. This isn't a joke that gets outgrown — it's the engine of the property. The same way Po's food obsession in Kung Fu Panda isn't a character flaw but the thing that makes his kung fu work, Kinnikuman's absurd fuel source is inseparable from his ability. Garlic, not steroids.

T

TERRYMAN

THE AMERICAN CHOJIN

Terryman. American. Cowboy. The face of Chojin wrestling in the US. Charming, photogenic, and commercially sharp — he trained in Japan and came home to build the sport stateside. He's a fighter and a promoter, and those two instincts are always at war. When he sees Kinnikuman, part of him recognizes a kindred spirit and part of him sees a meal ticket. Both are genuine.

He has a prosthetic leg he hides. Won't use his best move because of it. "We're all hiding something" — he says it to Kinnikuman and means it, but he also means it as manipulation. His arc is about choosing which instinct wins: the promoter or the friend.

骨

MEAT

THE LOYAL TRAINER

Meat (Meat Alexandria). Tiny. Skull-faced. Kinnikuman's trainer, advisor, and the one person who believed in him before anyone else. He's not comic relief — he's the emotional anchor. The brain paired with the heart. His function in the story is simple: he never leaves. Not when Kinnikuman pushes him away. Not when it's hopeless. That's friendship power. Not a magic system. A person who refuses to give up on you.

R

ROBIN MASK

THE REIGNING CHAMPION

Robin Mask. English. Aristocrat. The reigning champion. Technical perfection in ornate knight armor, handsome underneath, humiliated when his face is exposed. Robin is everything Kinnikuman was supposed to be — and he knows it. He's not a villain. He's the standard. The system that says identity is assigned by tradition, by bloodline, by the machine that chooses your mask.

His fight with Kinnikuman isn't about who's stronger. It's about whether the system's definition of "worthy" is the only one that counts. Robin's long-term arc across the franchise turns him into one of Kinnikuman's closest allies. In this film, we just see the first crack.



KING KINNIKU

THE SHADOW

King Kinniku. Never on screen. His shadow is the whole movie. The father who dropped his son from a spaceship because the mask looked wrong. He's the voice in Kinnikuman's head that says the shame is deserved.

THE FOUNDATION

THE FIVE PILLARS

These are the non-negotiable elements of any Kinnikuman story. They're the reason 85 million copies exist, and every one of them is present in this film:

THE UNWORTHY PRINCE

1

Born royal, rejected for not looking the part. The wound that drives everything.

WINNING ON HEART, NOT SKILL

2

He doesn't get better. He gets braver. His body fights when his mind gives up.

GARLIC, NOT STEROIDS

3

The comedy IS the power system. The absurd fuel source that embarrasses everyone and saves the day.

THE MASK AS IDENTITY

4

Randomly assigned, must be earned through action. Robin believes the mask defines you. Kinnikuman proves you define the mask.

RESPECT EARNED THROUGH REFUSAL TO DIE

Three asks. Three refusals. The crowd shifts from booing to chanting. This is the pattern that converts enemies into allies across every arc of the manga.

THE COLLABORATION

HONORING THE SOURCE

This treatment takes a big liberty: it tells a new story. The setting is different. The structure is original. Several character dynamics have been reimagined for a fresh audience.

But the characters are sacred. The emotional core is sacred. The mask mythology, the comedy-first tone, the way enemies become friends, the garlic — these belong to Yudetamago, and we wouldn't change them without their guidance.

Here's where we'd want the creators' input before going further:

MEAT'S BACKSTORY

We have him arriving from Japan to find his prince. An alternative is reimagining him as an American trainer who discovers Kinnikuman independently — a Rocky/Mickey dynamic with the same heart. We lean toward the original version, but this is a conversation.

TIME PERIOD

1980s (Hulkamania era, no smartphones, the M.U.S.C.L.E. toy era) or present day. There's a strong case for the '80s — it's when this property first touched America, and the era's obsession with personal branding fits Terryman's story perfectly.

ROBIN MASK'S BACKING

Is he acting alone, or is someone behind him? If Kinnikuman's father sent the Japanese contingent, that's a sequel seed that changes the weight of the whole third act.

HOW FAR CAN WE GO WITH KINNIKUMAN'S LOOK IN ACT 1? HE ALWAYS HAS THE MASK — IT IS HIS FACE

But the KIN mark on his forehead, the fin — how much can we play with hiding those in the anonymous phase?

THE AMERICAN CHOJIN

Do we adapt existing characters from the manga for the US circuit, or create new ones? Both approaches have value.

THE CROWN

It's seeded in this film but not resolved. How present should the throne question be? Our instinct is to keep it in the background — Film 1 is about earning self-respect, not a crown. But if the creators feel the royal stakes should be more active, there's room.

This treatment is an invitation to collaborate. The goal is to take a property that two creators have poured their lives into and translate it into something that a new audience can fall in love with — without losing a single thing that made 85 million readers fall in love with it first.

THE OPPORTUNITY

THE OPPORTUNITY

Kinnikuman is the most commercially proven Japanese IP that has never been properly introduced to Western audiences. The timing has never been better, and the path has never been clearer.

85M MANGA COPIES SOLD WORLDWIDE	525M HOURS OF WWE CONTENT WATCHED ON NETFLIX	\$795M DEMON SLAYER BOX OFFICE WORLDWIDE

\$1.4B

SUPER MARIO BROS. MOVIE
WORLDWIDE GROSS

180M

KINKESHI FIGURES
SOLD IN JAPAN

418

UNIQUE CHARACTER DESIGNS
IN THE MANGA

WRESTLING

WWE moved to Netflix in January 2025. 525 million hours of content watched. Over 3 million weekly viewers. John Cena's retirement tour, The Rock's return. Wrestling audiences are massive, engaged, and already on the platform most likely to partner on distribution. There is no prestige animated wrestling property. Zero. The lane is wide open.

BOX OFFICE

Demon Slayer: Infinity Castle grossed \$795 million worldwide on a \$20 million budget — the highest-grossing international film ever in North America. Spider-Verse did \$690 million. Mario did \$1.4 billion. Inside Out 2 did \$1.6 billion. Animation isn't a limitation. It's the highest-performing theatrical format.

THE ROCKY COMP

Rocky was made for under \$1 million and grossed \$225 million. The franchise has generated over \$1.5 billion across nine films. It proved that an underdog fighting story isn't a niche genre — it's one of the most durable franchise engines in Hollywood. Kinnikuman is that engine with 45 years of built-in mythology, a pre-existing character roster, and a global fanbase.

M.U.S.C.L.E.

In 1985, Mattel brought Kinnikuman's toy line to America as M.U.S.C.L.E. — Millions of Unusual Small Creatures Lurking Everywhere. The figures sold without any story or character names, purely on the strength of the designs. Top-10 toy line of 1986. Millions of Americans now aged 35–50 collected these as kids and have no idea they were Kinnikuman characters. This film gives them the story behind the toys — the same nostalgia mechanism that helped power the Super Mario Bros. Movie to \$1.4 billion.

FRANCHISE

Film 1 is a complete story. But the manga provides a natural roadmap: a tag team tournament sequel, a royal succession saga for Film 3, and a next-generation series for streaming. 418 unique character designs. Named signature moves for every fighter. Three worldview factions that create natural sequel conflict. And the property's defining long-term pattern — every enemy becomes an ally — means the roster only grows. Every film's antagonist becomes the next film's most beloved character.

TOYS, GAMES, AND BEYOND

180 million Kinkeshi figures sold in Japan. The character designs are a toy line waiting to be relaunched. 418 fighters with unique moves is a fighting game roster that already exists. IMAX potential is built into the choreography — the Kinniku Buster is designed as a vertical, high-impact money shot. WWE crossover and live event potential given the wrestling foundation. The commercial surface area of this property is enormous and almost entirely untapped outside Japan.

キン肉マン・イン・アメリカ

MUSCLE MAN

WRITTEN BY MAX COYNE-GREEN

PRODUCED BY FRANKIE SERATCH

IP BAY

FEBRUARY 2026 · CONFIDENTIAL

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